

It's a deal

Instead of writing their names, the Sumerian traders used a seal to sign their contracts.



Flooded fields

Mesopotamia was watered by the Tigris and Euphrates, which flooded in the spring.

The farmers dug out basins and canals so the river water could be stored and used to water fields away from the river. Because of this, land was very fertile and harvests were good.

Wood was imported from Syria and the Lebanon.

Wheeled carts were able to carry heavy objects over long distances.

Pots were used to store grain and oil.

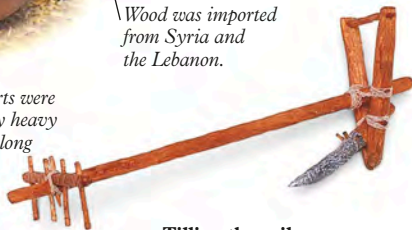


Spokes



Tilling the soil

The first plows were made of wood. Later, the blade was made of bronze. Despite the flooding from the rivers, the ground in Sumer was baked hard in hot weather. The plow made it possible to break up the hard-to-work soil.



Revolutionary invention

The first wheels were made of planks of solid wood held together with crosspieces.

They were clumsy and heavy. In time, lighter wheels were made. These had many spokes.

